

BID TO HOST THE 14TH GLOBAL RCE CONFERENCE IN 2025 IN KAMPALA, UGANDA





Submitted by

RCE Greater Eastern Uganda, RCE Greater Masaka in collaboration with

The Uganda Convention Bureau

UGANDA
CONVENTION BUREAU

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Executive SUMMARY

About the RCE Networks in Uganda

RCE Greater Eastern Uganda

The Main RCE Contact is Assoc Professor Dr. Edward Andama

RCE Greater Masaka in collaboration

The Main RCE Contact is Br. Aloysius Byaruhanga, Uganda Martyrs University, alloysiusbyaruhanga49@gmail.com

Host City

With a population of roughly 2.5 million, the predominant language is English, Kampala is Uganda's largest urban centre. The city offers a dynamic business environment with a strategic location in East Africa. Entebbe International Airport, the primary gateway to Uganda, is approximately 40 kilometres or 45 minutes from Kampala. The city boasts international brand hotels, including Serena Hotels, Sheraton Hotels, and Marriott International. The city's economy is driven by key industries which include telecommunications, finance, tourism, and construction. The city's ICCA's ranking as 4th in Africa for the most association meetings held in 2023, is a testament to the country's drive to become a premier business events destination. It was selected as the lead City among the Twelve (12) African cities in the Africa Smart Towns Network (ASToN).

Suggested Theme

"Achieving the Sustainable Development Goals: through promoting access and quality in education for all."

Relevance of theme

"To address issues affecting the low enrollment and completion rates in developing countries. The developing world and especially Africa is still grappling with high dropout rates in education systems for all categories of living systems."

Suggested Dates

Plan A: 4TH – 5TH September 2025

Plan B: 3RD – 5th September 2025

Plan C: 10TH – 12TH September 2025

Reason: Parliamentary elections kick off in November 2025, the earlier the conference is held, the more convenient it is for budget planning purposes and delegates' participation

Suggested Venue

Sheraton Kampala Hotel

Past Events

The 6th Mashariki (Eastern African) Literary & Cultural Studies Conference, 2023

Distance Education and Teachers' Training in Africa (DETA) Conference, 2023

5th Biennial African Philosophy World Conference (APWC), 2023

27th Conference of Speakers & Presiding Officers of Commonwealth, 2024

11th Africa Society for Blood Transfusion Congress, March 2024

ITU The Global Symposium for Regulators (GSR-24), July 2024

Objectives

Share knowledge and discuss ideas

Foster collaboration

Monitor and evaluate progress

Energize future efforts

Outcomes

A new set of recommendations for strengthening the RCE network and its impact on ESD.

Increased collaboration between RCEs on joint projects and initiatives.

A renewed commitment from governments & other stakeholders to support ESD.

A more informed and engaged global citizenry on sustainability issues.

Support and Endorsement

National Environmental Management Authority

Uganda National Commission for UNESCO

Uganda Martyrs University

Uganda Convention Bureau

Air Access and Transport

Air access: Uganda Airlines, the national airline carrier has 6 aircrafts that fly to 20 destinations

International airline carriers: <https://www.exploreuganda.com/airlines-flying-to-uganda/>

From the Airport: 30 minutes via the Expressway (has road tolls)

From accommodation to conference venue: 5-15 minutes via electric buses (Kiira EV buses)

From the Airport to Hotel accommodation: Hotel airport pickup and dropoff as requested by the hotel guests /local DMC

Affordable and accessible accommodation

Hotels around and in Kampala. There are approximately 10 three-star to five-star hotels close to the proposed conference venue location for the start of the Global RCE Conference 2025. The price ranges from USD \$ 70 - USD \$ 250.

Reasonable Meals and Beverages

Kampala's culinary scene offers a diverse range of local and international cuisines, from traditional Ugandan dishes like matoke (steamed plantain), lwombo, and Rolex (fried eggs in a wrap). The average cost of a meal with a drink in Kampala hotels/ restaurants; buffet serving is between \$7 – \$ 28 and a la carte menu in Kampala Hotels/ restaurants is between \$9 – \$21.

Kampala's vibrant food scene also offers a wide range of international cuisines, including Indian, Chinese, Italian, and Lebanese.

Eco-tourism

When hosting the conference, we intend to carry out activities that contribute to the creation of a sustainable conference environment; sustainable venue selection, low carbon emission transportation, local sourcing of suppliers, waste reduction, educational workshops, and legacy projects.

Expression of INTEREST

Global RCE Service Centre,
United Nations University,
Institute for the Advanced Study of Sustainability,
Tokyo, Japan,

**SUBJECT: EXPRESSION OF INTEREST TO HOST THE 14TH GLOBAL RCE
CONFERENCE IN 2025**

We are writing on behalf of a collaborative effort between the RCE Greater Masaka (RCEGM) and RCE Greater Eastern Uganda (GEURCE), both affiliates of the global RCE network in Uganda. We are partnering with the Uganda Convention Bureau to express our strong interest in hosting the 14th Global RCE Conference in 2025.

RCE Greater Masaka (RCEGM): Based at Uganda Martyrs University in Nkozi the university leadership actively supports RCEGM's initiatives, demonstrating a strong institutional commitment to these goals. RCE Greater Eastern Uganda (GEURCE): GEURCE is a consortium of organizations, including local governments, businesses, and NGOs, encompassing 32 districts within the Lake Victoria area, the southeastern Lake Kyoga basin, and the farming zones between Jinja and Mbale.

As per the announcement made on Friday 16th August 2024, we are delighted to learn that the Global RCE Network has invited all member networks to consider submitting a bid to host the Global RCE Conference in 2025. This invitation has motivated us to submit this bid to host the prestigious event. It is worth sharing that Uganda hosted the 5th African RCE Conference in 2015 <https://www.rcenetwork.org/portal/5th-african-rce-conference>. The conference opened the door for African RCEs to contribute more to sustainable development in Africa, as a group in line with GAP and the SDGs.

Additionally, Uganda has hosted 16th African Dairy Conference And Exhibition in 2023, African Grain Council Summit 2023, The East African Business and Investment Summit 2023, The 2023 Scientific Meeting of the Global Foot and Mouth Disease Research Alliance (GFRA) to mention a few.

In this context, we are submitting this expression of interest to host the Global RCE conference in 2025. The event will provide a platform to highlight Uganda's leadership in implementing sustainable development principles and practices, strengthen global collaboration among RCE networks worldwide, and highlight Local efforts undertaken by RCEGM, GEURCE, and other stakeholders in promoting sustainable development in Uganda.

Thank you for considering our expression of interest. We look forward to the opportunity to discuss our proposal further.

Sincerely,



Br BYARUHANGA Aloysius
RCE Greater Masaka



Assoc. Prof. ANDAMA Edward
RCE Greater Eastern Uganda

On Behalf of RCE Greater Masaka and RCE Greater Eastern Uganda

Host

MEMBER NETWORKS

RCE Greater Eastern Uganda

RCE Greater Eastern Uganda (GEURCE) is a network of member organizations ranging from local government to private sector and non-government organizations (NGOs) that aims to create interconnected, diverse communities that live sustainably in eastern and northeastern Uganda. GEURCE covers 32 local government districts within the Lake Victoria crescent, the southern-eastern Lake Kyoga basin, and Uganda's Jinja-Mbale agroecological farmland zones.

The Main RCE Contact is Associate Professor Dr. Edward Andama

RCE Greater Masaka in collaboration

Uganda Martyrs University Nkozi hosts the Regional Centre of Expertise Greater Masaka (RCEGM). The University's mandate is to teach, research, and community engagements. The leadership of Uganda Martyrs University has been at the forefront of the institutionalization and propelling of the activities to initiate and host the Greater Masaka Regional Centre of Excellence (RCEGM) and the proposed activities in general. The University affirmed its commitment to work with different stakeholders to promote the activities of RCEGM. The RCEGM consists of the South – Eastern part of the Lake Victoria crescent which includes 12 districts, namely; Bukomansimbi, Butambala, Gomba, Kalangala, Kalungu, Kyotera, Lwengo, Lyantonde, Masaka, Mityana, Mpigi, Rakai and Ssembabule

The Main RCE Contact is Br. Aloysius Byaruhanga, Uganda Martyrs University

Why HOST?

Proposed theme and relevance of theme to the region

Theme: “Achieving the Sustainable Development Goals: through promoting access and quality in education for all.”

Relevance: “To address issues affecting the low enrollment and completion rates in developing countries. The developing world and especially Africa is still grappling with high dropout rates in education systems for all categories of living systems.”

Objectives

- a) Share knowledge and discuss ideas: The conference can provide a platform for RCE members from around the world to share their experiences, best practices, and challenges in implementing Education for Sustainable Development (ESD). This can help to identify new approaches and strategies for advancing ESD globally.
- b) Foster collaboration: The conference can bring together stakeholders from different sectors, including academia, government, civil society, and the private sector, to collaborate on ESD initiatives. This can help to create a more coordinated and effective approach to ESD.
- c) Monitor and evaluate progress: The conference can provide an opportunity to take stock of progress made towards achieving the SDGs through ESD. This can help to identify areas where more effort is needed and to make adjustments to the RCE strategy.
- d) Energize future efforts: The conference can help to energize and motivate RCE members to continue their work in promoting ESD. This can be especially important in light of the challenges facing the world today, such as climate change and inequality.

Outcomes

- 1. Enhanced RCE Network and ESD Impact:
 - a) A comprehensive RCE Framework: A refined framework outlining the roles, responsibilities, and best practices of RCEs, providing clear guidelines for future operations.

- b) A Global RCE Strategy: A strategic plan for the global RCE network, outlining key priorities, goals, and action plans for the next five years.
- c) A Knowledge Sharing Platform: A robust online platform for RCE members to share resources, best practices, and lessons learned.

2. Increased Collaboration and Partnerships:

- a) Joint Projects and Initiatives: The formation of collaborative partnerships between RCEs to address specific regional or global challenges, such as climate change, biodiversity loss, and sustainable consumption and production.
- b) Capacity Building Programs: The development of capacity-building programs to strengthen the skills and knowledge of RCE members in areas such as project management, communication, and fundraising.
- c) Networking Opportunities: The establishment of strong networks between RCE members, policymakers, businesses, and civil society organizations to facilitate collaboration and knowledge exchange.

3. Renewed Commitment to ESD:

- a) Policy Recommendations: A set of policy recommendations for governments and international organizations to promote ESD and integrate it into national education and development plans.
- b) Increased Funding: Increased funding for ESD initiatives, including RCE activities, from governments, foundations, and the private sector.
- c) Public-Private Partnerships: The formation of public-private partnerships to support ESD initiatives and promote sustainable business practices.

4. A More Informed and Engaged Global Citizenry:

- a) Public Awareness Campaigns: The development and implementation of public awareness campaigns to raise awareness of ESD and its importance.
- b) Educational Materials: The creation of high-quality educational materials, such as lesson plans, curricula, and online courses, to promote ESD in schools and communities.
- c) Youth Engagement: The empowerment of young people as agents of change through youth-led initiatives and programs.



About UGANDA

Uganda, aptly named the Pearl of Africa, combines unparalleled natural beauty, rich cultural heritage, a vibrant youthful entrepreneurial population and genuine hospitality, creating an irresistible allure for all who explore.

Receiving the Investment Catalyst Award at the 2023 Go Global Awards acknowledges Uganda's success in attracting significant investment projects that significantly contribute to economic growth and development. This recognition underscores Uganda's robust entrepreneurial spirit.

Ranked seventh among the top ten African destinations for hosting the most association meetings in 2023 by the International Congress and Conference Association (ICCA), this location has also received recognition from the World Bank for an expected GDP growth rate of 6% in 2024. This places it as the second-fastest growing economy within the East African Community.

Uganda, with its capital city Kampala, has effectively hosted a series of significant events, including the Regional Cybersecurity Summit for Africa (2023), the Africa Blockchain Conference (2022), the Non-Aligned Movement (2024), the Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth (2024), ITU Global Symposium for Regulators (GSR-24) and the 11th Congress of the Africa and Indian Ocean Commission. Additionally, the city will welcome the IADR East & Southern

Africa Division/Uganda Dental Association (UDA) Joint Conference in 2024. These events underscore Uganda's credibility and desirability as a premier venue for meetings and conferences.

Having enjoyed a safe and secure business environment for close to 40 years, this has promoted Uganda as a premier African destination for meetings and leisure tourism. A destination that lies on the equator, surrounded by 2 great rift valleys, home to the source of the longest river in Africa and one of the largest freshwater lakes in the world, Uganda's climate is a vibrant tapestry woven with sunshine and refreshing showers. This eternal dance keeps temperatures comfortable, the landscapes lush, and your thirst for adventure quenched.

The Uganda Convention Bureau extends a warm welcome to the delegates of the Global RCE Conference in Kampala, Uganda. We are committed to playing an integral role in ensuring a successful and impactful conference.

Legacy for Uganda

Africa RCE have been key in promoting sustainable developments in nature based solution and education programs. Ugandan RCEs are the key in community mobilization for promoting community wide education to adopting nature based solutions as strategy for sustainable development.





Country HIGHLIGHTS



Uganda ranks 5th in ICCA Africa chapter as a preferred MICE destination (ICCA report, 2023)



Kampala city ranks 4th in Africa as a preferred MICE destination (ICCA report, 2023)



Presence of an active Convention Bureau



Uganda is ranked 6th in Africa as a preferred MICE destination (ICCA report, 2019)



Uganda is the fastest growing economy in EAC with GDP of over \$40.43 billion, World Bank 2021



Uganda has the highest adult literacy in East Africa Community (EAC), workforce age 15-24 about 90%



Uganda ranked 11th best in Sub-Saharan Africa for Gender Gap Index report, 2022



Working to make it a clean city



Uganda is the world's friendliest country for expat families. Uganda tops list of the friendliest destination expats families, 2024



Uganda ranks higher than USA in the latest Global Peace Index, January 2023, chimp report



About the host city

KAMPALA

Where Does Kampala Get Its Name?

The history of this beautiful African city is wrapped in both historical facts and folklore. Based on the folklore this city was dominated by swamps and hills which form natural breeding grounds for Impala and other members of the antelope family.

The Kabaka or King of Buganda ruled this place and turned the hills into his hunting grounds. When the British arrived here at the end of the 19th century, they named this place, the "Hill of the Impala" because this place was frequented by large numbers

of Impala which belongs to the antelope family. Due to the blending of the names, this place got its current name, Kampala.

As one of Uganda's 2 main business hubs, located 30 minutes from the country's main international airport, Kampala is not only the heart of Uganda but also its commercial and political centre.

With a population of roughly 2.5 million, Kampala is Uganda's largest urban centre. With the predominant language being

English, with the friendliest people in Africa, always with having a smile, communicative and proud of their city's history and vibrancy.

As a bustling commercial capital, Kampala is home to some of the global name-brand hotels which include; Sheraton Kampala Hotel, Kampala Serena Hotel, Protea Hotel by Marriott Kampala, Four Points by Sheraton Kampala, and Hilton Garden Inn Kampala. These brands and Kampala ICCA's ranking as 4th in Africa for association meetings is a testament to the country's drive to become a successful business events destination.

Kampala City edged 12 African Cities to claim a lead City role in the Africa Smart Towns Network. It was selected as the lead City among the Twelve (12) African cities in the Africa Smart Towns Network (ASToN). Explore Uganda, the Pearl of Africa.









Accessibility VISA

- A. All persons visiting Uganda for holiday, tourism, business, study, visit or medical are required to apply and obtain a visa online. The 4-step process is fast, seamless and convenient.

Tourist visa applications can be completed and paid for online at;

DIRECTORATE of CITIZENSHIP and IMMIGRATION CONTROL
MINISTRY of INTERNAL AFFAIRS - REPUBLIC of UGANDA
UGANDA E-IMMIGRATION SYSTEM

HOME APPLICATIONS VISA/PERMIT HELP CONTACT

Welcome to Uganda Electronic Visa/Permit Application System

Visiting the Pearl of Africa for business or Pleasure has never been easier.

Home to the source of the world's longest river (river Nile), the world's remaining Mountain Gorillas, vast and diverse natural wild life reserves; Blessed with tropical, all year round summer weather, a diverse cultural heritage of over 50 local tribes, snow caped mountains, natural water rafting spots, vibrant night life. A wealth of unexploited natural resources and a young educated population.

Choose Uganda as your next holiday destination and experience true African hospitality.

Application process

- STEP 1
Application type
- STEP 2
Fill the form
- STEP 3
Add documents
- STEP 4
Submit

[Start a new application](#)

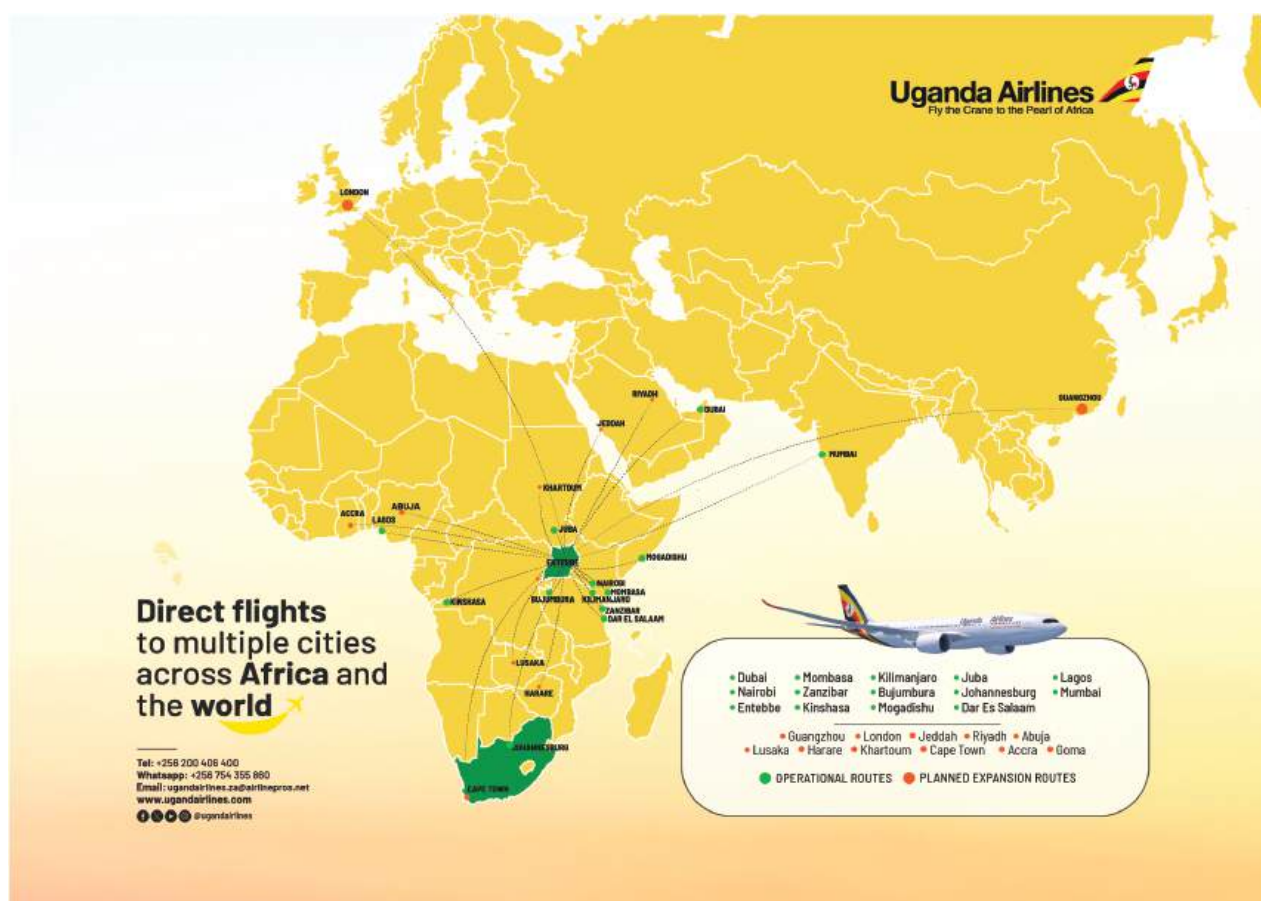
Link: visas.immigration.go.ug/

- B. A Ugandan tourist visa costs \$ 50. A six-month valid passport is required for travellers visiting from North America, Europe and other international markets.
- C. Travelers planning to visit multiple countries can apply for the East Africa Tourist Visa, which allows for travel between Kenya, Rwanda, and Uganda for 90 days for \$100 USD.

Airline

Uganda Airlines, the national airline carrier has 6 aircrafts that fly to 20 destinations with a regular network of routes each day with morning departures from Entebbe International Airport and late-night arrivals.

Flight connections include destinations such as Nairobi, Nigeria, Guangzhou, London, Johannesburg, Dubai, Mumbai and Zanzibar



International airlines:



Inter-continental airlines:





Tours

Technical tours to:

- a) Key RCE Greater Eastern Uganda projects
- b) Key RCE Greater Kampala projects
- c) Key RCE Greater Masaka projects

Recommended PCOs

Byuga Events

Legend Events

Recommended DMCs

Gazelle Safari Company (Member of the Society of Incentive Travel Excellence-SITE)

MICE Uganda (Member of the Society of Incentive Travel Excellence-SITE)

Explore Uganda

THE PEARL OF AFRICA

Uniquely ours, uniquely yours!

Follow the Link to explore the Pearl of Africa

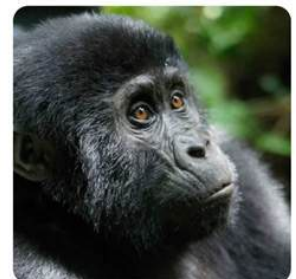
<https://youtu.be/SJrIPSPuASU?si=CYts-Kly2kHVh1CI>



Let's take you on a journey of discovery



Uganda is a multicultural country in East Africa whose diverse landscape spans from the beautiful snow-capped Rwenzori Mountains to the intimately vast Lake Victoria, the source of the great River Nile





Recommended **CONFERENCE VENUE**

Sheraton Hotel Kampala

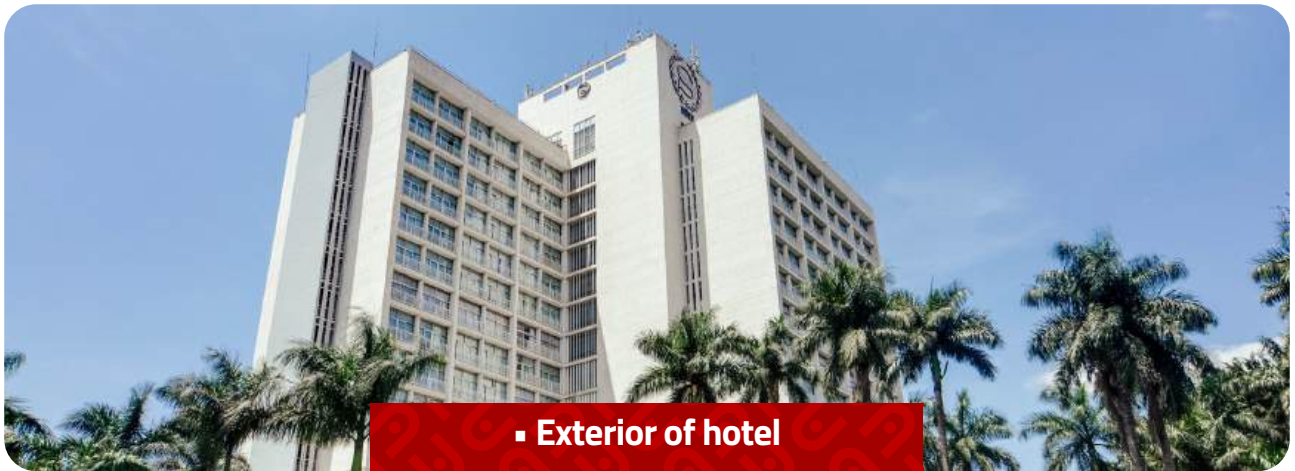
Kampala, Uganda

Address: Ternan Avenue, P. O. Box 7041, Kampala, Uganda

Tel: +256 31-2322499

Website: <https://www.marriott.com/en-us/hotels/ebbsi-sheraton-kampala-hotel/overview/>

5 star hotel is ideally situated in Kampala, the capital of Uganda, 45 minutes / 40kms (24miles) from Entebbe International Airport, and less than 10 minutes away from the central business district. Take in sweeping views of the Kampala skyline from the comfort of our vibrant and stylish hotel, surrounded by 9 acres of well-manicured gardens. With 236 spacious guest rooms and suites, a state-of-the-art fitness centre, a hotel spa and 8 restaurants, 8 meeting rooms with a capacity range of 11-100, and 2 conference rooms with capacity of 40-400.



▪ Exterior of hotel



▪ Accommodation rooms



▪ Recent conference at the venue



▪ Conference Room

Potential ACCOMODATION VENUES

Hotel Name	Price Range	Address
1. Hotel Ruch Kampala	\$60 per night	Hotel Ruch, Plot 3 Kintu Rd, Kampala
2. Red Chilli Hideaway	\$20 - \$50 per night	Lugogo Bypass, Kampala, Uganda
3. Kampala Serena Hotel	\$150 - \$250 per night	P.O. Box 7814, Kintu Road, Kampala, Uganda
4. Speke Hotel Kampala	\$100 - \$200 per night	Plot 7, Nile Avenue, Kampala, Uganda
5. Hotel Africana	\$120 - \$200 per night	1-3 Port Bell Road, Kampala, Uganda
6. Grand Imperial Hotel	\$119 per night	Plot 2A/B/P.O.Box 7048 Colville St, Kampala
7. Imperial Royale Hotel	\$153 per night	P.O.Box 4326 Kampala / Plot 7 Kintu Rd, Kampala
8. Sheraton Kampala Hotel	\$250 - \$400 per night	Ternan Avenue, Kampala, Uganda
9. Pearl of Africa Hotel	\$250 - \$500 per night	Nakasero Hill, Plot 10A, Kampala, Uganda
10. The Emin Pasha Hotel	\$200 - \$350 per night	17A, Acacia Avenue, Kololo, Kampala, Uganda





Health and **SAFETY**

The country's political stability under the current government leadership has played a significant role in enhancing safety for visitors. This stability has fostered a conducive environment for tourism, encouraging a steady influx of international travelers.

Popular destinations like Kampala, Entebbe, and the national parks are well-patrolled, and the local authorities work diligently to ensure the safety of visitors.

For instance, organized tours for activities such as gorilla trekking in Bwindi Impenetrable Forest and chimpanzee tracking in Kibale National Park are conducted under stringent safety protocols. These measures ensure tourists can enjoy

close encounters with Uganda's unique wildlife without concerns for their safety.

The Ugandan government has also made significant strides in improving road safety and reducing crime. Efforts to enhance infrastructure and enforce traffic regulations have contributed to safer travel experiences for tourists. Additionally, community tourism initiatives have been instrumental in creating a welcoming and secure atmosphere for

international visitors. These initiatives involve local communities in tourism activities, promoting a sense of shared responsibility for the safety and satisfaction of tourists.

Health services in Uganda have seen substantial improvements, with modern hospitals and clinics available in major cities like Kampala and Entebbe. These facilities are equipped to handle medical needs that tourists might have, further enhancing the sense of security for visitors. The combination of these positive security measures and the country's breathtaking natural beauty makes Uganda a must-visit destination for those seeking both adventure and safety.

Tentative Budget

BUDGET SHEET TO HOST THE 14TH GLOBAL RCE CONFERENCE 2025 IN KAMPALA, UGANDA

ITEM	PAX	UNIT COST	NO. DAYS	TOTAL USD.	UGX RATE 15.11.24	TOTAL UGX
A.						
VENUE						
Plenary - day delegate package <i>Rwenzori ballroom full day morning, evening break teas water, lunch + soft drink internet + stationery</i>	400	50	3	60,000	3,665	219,910,800
Translators						
French	5	450	3	6,750	3,665	24,739,965
German	5	450	3	6,750	3,665	24,739,965
Equipment						
translation	2	1,000	3	6,000	3,665	21,991,080
Public address system	1	176	3	528	3,665	1,935,215
Projector	1	68	3	204	3,665	747,697
LED Screens + stage lighting	1	2,700	3	8,100	3,665	29,687,958
Breakout rooms x5						
Victoria Hall	1	2,000	3	6,000	3,665	21,991,080
Seven hills	1	1,322	3	3,966	3,665	14,536,104
Forest room	1	1,322	3	3,966	3,665	14,536,104
lake room	1	1,322	3	3,966	3,665	14,536,104
Exhibitions						
well draped tent <i>potentially 20 exhibitors</i>	1	1,322	3	3,966	3,665	14,536,104
Accommodation						
keynote speakers	3	160	3	1,440	3,665	5,277,859
Executive room on BB RCE Regional Advisors Executive room on BB	5	160	3	2,400	3,665	8,796,432
Gala Dinner <i>on day 1</i>	400	37	1	14,800	3,665	54,244,664
Opening Ceremony <i>cultural entertainment</i>	1	546	1	546	3,665	2,001,188
B.						
TRANSPORT						
keynote speakers	3	60	2	360	3,665	1,319,465
RCE Regional Advisors	5	60	2	600	3,665	2,199,108
C.						
TECHNICAL TOURS						
4 sites visits	2	200	2	800	3,665	2,932,144
D.						
Site Inspection <i>Pre destination visits are Catered for by UCB</i>				131,142		480,659,036
E.						
10% CONTINGENCY				13,114.20		48,065,903.56
TOTAL				144,256		528,724,939
VAT 18%				25,966.12		95,170,489.04
NET TOTAL SPEND				170,222		623,895,428

Tentative **PROGRAMME**

GLOBAL RCE CONFERENCE 2025: UGANDA

Date: 4th–5th September 2025

Location: Kampala, Uganda

Day 1: 4th September 2025

08:00 - 09:00 | Registration and Welcome Coffee

- Participants register and enjoy a light morning coffee while networking.
- Venue: Conference Lobby

09:00 - 09:30 | Opening Remarks

- Official opening by the Conference Chair and key Ugandan dignitaries.(Minister of Water and Environment)
- Brief overview of the conference objectives and schedule.
- Speaker(s): RCE Uganda Representative, Key Government Official (NEMA, UNESCO, VC Uganda Martyrs University)
- Venue: Main conference hall

09:30 - 10:30 | Introductory Session: Sustainability in Uganda

- An overview of Uganda's sustainability challenges and the role of RCEs in addressing them.
- Speaker(s): Local Sustainability Expert, RCE Greater Masaka Leader
- Venue: Main conference hall

10:30 - 11:00 | Coffee Break

- Networking and refreshments.

11:00 - 12:30 | Plenary Session I: Keynote Address – Sustainability Challenges in Uganda

- Keynote by a prominent figure in the sustainability field (e.g., government official, international expert).
- Focus: Uganda's current sustainability issues and the need for systemic change.
- Speaker: [TBC]
- Venue: Main conference hall

12:30 - 13:30 | Lunch Break

- Buffet-style lunch with local dishes.
- Venue: Dining Area

13:30 - 15:00 | Plenary Session II: Keynote Address – Global Sustainability Trends and the Role of RCEs

- Keynote on global sustainability initiatives, with emphasis on the role of RCEs in promoting local solutions.
- Speaker: [TBC]
- Venue: Main conference hall

15:00 - 15:30 | Afternoon Tea and Networking

- Light refreshments and an opportunity to network.

15:30 - 17:00 | Parallel Sessions I

- Session 1A: Sustainable Agriculture in Uganda: Challenges and Solutions
- Session 1B: Climate Change Adaptation and Mitigation in Uganda
- Session 1C: Education for Sustainable Development in Uganda
- Venue: Breakout Rooms

17:00 - 17:30 | Break

- Short break before the next session.

17:30 - 19:00 | Parallel Sessions II

- Session 2A: Renewable Energy and Rural Development in Uganda

- Session 2B: Conservation and Biodiversity Protection in Uganda
- Session 2C: Urban Sustainability and Infrastructure Challenges
- Venue: Breakout Rooms

19:00 - 20:30 | Evening Reception and Networking

- Informal networking event with drinks and light snacks.
- Venue: Hotel

Day 2: 5th September 2025

08:30 - 09:00 | Morning Coffee and Networking

- Networking opportunity to kick-start Day 2.

09:00 - 10:30 | Regional Focus Sessions: Best Practices from RCEs Around the World

- Session 1: Africa – Sustainability and Development Challenges in the African Context
- Session 2: Americas – Best Practices in Indigenous Knowledge for Sustainability
- Session 3: Asia-Pacific – Innovations in Renewable Energy and Sustainability
- Session 4: Europe – Policy and Governance for Sustainable Development
- Venue: Breakout Rooms

10:30 - 11:00 | Coffee Break

- Light refreshments.

11:00 - 12:30 | Workshop Sessions I: Collaborative Approaches to Sustainability

- Workshop 1A: Integrating Local Communities in Sustainability Initiatives
- Workshop 1B: Education for Sustainability: How to Engage the Next Generation
- Workshop 1C: Developing Effective Sustainability Policies
- Venue: Breakout Rooms

12:30 - 13:30 | Lunch Break

- Buffet-style lunch with local and international cuisine.
- Venue: Dining Area

13:30 - 15:00 | Workshop Sessions II: Focus on Ugandan Sustainability Priorities

- Workshop 2A: Sustainable Water Management in Uganda
- Workshop 2B: Enhancing Agricultural Productivity While Protecting the Environment
- Workshop 2C: Building Resilient Communities in the Face of Climate Change
- Venue: Breakout Rooms

15:00 - 15:30 | Afternoon Tea and Networking

- Light refreshments and informal networking.

15:30 - 16:30 | Plenary Session III: High-Level Panel Discussion – Moving Towards Sustainable Solutions

- Panel discussion with regional experts, policymakers, and community leaders on actionable next steps for sustainability in Uganda and the global RCE network.
- Moderator: [TBC]
- Panelists: [TBC]
- Venue: Main Auditorium

16:30 - 17:00 | Closing Ceremony and Summary of Key Takeaways

- Recap of the conference, key findings, and outlook for future collaboration.
- Closing remarks and thank you by the organizing committee.
- Speaker: [TBC]
- Venue: Main Auditorium

17:00 - 18:00 | RCE Awards Ceremony

- Recognition of outstanding RCE projects that have contributed significantly to sustainable development.

- Award categories: Innovation, Community Engagement, Education, Policy Advocacy.
- Venue: Main Auditorium

18:00 - 19:00 | Farewell Networking Cocktail

- A final networking opportunity with drinks and snacks to conclude the conference.
- Venue: Hotel/Conference Center

Additional Considerations:

- **Technical and social Trips:** Optional field trips on the 3rd or 6th of September to showcase sustainable initiatives in Uganda, such as visits to community-based renewable energy projects, agricultural cooperatives, or wildlife conservation areas.
- **Networking Events:** Throughout the conference, there will be dedicated informal spaces for networking, workshops, including coffee breaks and a formal reception on Day

This structure is designed to ensure a balanced combination of keynote addresses, plenary sessions, interactive workshops, and networking opportunities, with a strong focus on both global sustainability issues and Uganda's specific challenges and solutions.

Support LETTERS

UGANDA TOURISM BOARD

UTB/CEO/QA/MICE/002

14th November 2024

Global RCE Service Centre,
United Nations University,
Institute for the Advanced Study of Sustainability,
Tokyo, Japan

SUBJECT: BID TO HOST THE 14TH GLOBAL REGIONAL CENTRES OF EXPERTISE CONFERENCE, 2025

Uganda Tourism Board (UTB) is a statutory organization responsible for sustainably promoting Uganda as a Competitive Tourism Destination for Inclusive Development.

I am writing on behalf of the Uganda Convention Bureau (UCB), a unit within UTB to express our full support for Uganda's bid to host the 14th Global Regional Centres of Expertise (RCE) Conference in Kampala, Uganda.

UCB has identified two members of the Global RCE Network; RCE Greater Masaka and RCE Greater Eastern Uganda who have expressed interest in partnering to bid and host the 14th Global RCE Conference in Uganda.

Uganda's capability to host international conferences has been prominently demonstrated through various significant events. Notably, the country organized the 5th African RCE Conference in 2015. Additionally, Uganda has served as the host for the 27th Conference of Speakers and Presiding Officers of the Commonwealth (CSPOC) in 2024, the 19th Summit of the Non-Aligned Movement in 2024, the 16th African Dairy Conference and Exhibition in 2023, the African Grain Council Summit in 2023, the East African Business and Investment Summit in 2023 among others. These events reflect Uganda's growing reputation as a premier business events destination for international discourse and collaboration.

UTB endorses the bid to host the Global RCE Conference 2025. We are confident that the conference will provide a platform to highlight Uganda's leadership in implementing sustainable development principles and practices, and will allow delegates to engage fully in the conference while experiencing the warmth and hospitality of Uganda, the Pearl of Africa.

For more information, please contact Mr. Paul Mugabo – Sales Officer on email paul.mugabo@utb.go.ug and telephone number +256 757 781 318.

Promoting Tourism Together


Office Of The CEO
UGANDA TOURISM BOARD
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Lilly AJAROVA
CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER



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PM/JO/SS
Vision: The Center Of Excellence in Destination Management in Africa.
Mission: To Sustainably Promote Uganda as a Competitive Tourism Destination for Inclusive Development.
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**FACULTY OF SCIENCE AND EDUCATION
OFFICE OF DEAN**

GLOBAL RCE SERVICE CENTRE:

United Nations University, Institute for the Advanced Study of Sustainability

5-53-70 Jingumae, Shibuya-ku, Tokyo 150-8925, Japan

**SUPPORT OF BID TO HOST 14th REGIONAL CENTRE OF EXPERTISE (RCE)
GLOBAL CONFERENCE 2025**

The Greater Eastern Regional Center of Expertise (RCE) was accredited by United Nations University Institute for advanced Sustainability (UNAIS) in 2012 and is one of the three active RCEs in Uganda, hosted at Busitema University and in particular Faculty of science and Education (FSE). I am writing on behalf of the Faculty and the University to support the bid to host the 14th Global Regional Centers of Expertise conference 2025. We are aware this will come about 10 years since RCE Greater Eastern Uganda in partnership with NEMA hosted the 5th African RCE Conference in 14-16 October, 2015, Entebbe, Uganda. RCE Eastern Uganda is ready and willing to again host the global RCE conference following the successful hosting of the African region conference. FSE has been at the fore front in promoting innovations in Education and Sciences within the university, Uganda and Africa at large. This fits well with the opportunity to show case of the effort in advancing sustainability education and to share best practices related to five priority areas of action outlined in UNESCO: Advancing policy transforming learning environments, building capacities of educators, empowering and mobilizing youth and accelerating local level actions.

With the above background we ready to host the global RCE conference 2025. We are partnerin to cohost with Greater Masaka RCE and the Uganda Convention center under Uganda Touris Board.

We shall be grateful for your positive evaluation and we prepare to host the event.

Thank you



Associate professor .David Kari Olema

Dean Faculty

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EXPLORE
UGANDA
THE PEARL OF AFRICA

UGANDA
CONVENTION BUREAU

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